

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The nature of Brahman: The nature of Brahman as spirit, ultimate reality or absolute truth; how the characteristics of Brahman are shown in Hindu scriptures, including Katha Upanishad 2.2.6–8.
1.2	The nature and importance of understanding Brahman as Nirguna Brahman and Saguna Brahman: how Nirguna Brahman and Saguna Brahman are shown in Hindu scripture, for example Nirguna (Taittiriya Upanishad 2.7.1–2) and Saguna (Rig Veda 1.154.1–2); the nature and importance of Vaikuntha (spiritual worlds); divergent ways in which belief in each may be expressed in the life of Hindus today.
1.3	Three aspects of the divine: Brahman, Antaryami and Bhagavan; the nature and significance of the divine as Brahman (everywhere and non-personal), Antaryami (within the heart) and Bhagavan (beyond, as a personal loving God); how the three aspects are shown in Hindu scriptures, including Mundaka Upanishad 2.1; why belief in the three aspects of the divine are important in Hindu life and for religious pluralism today.
1.4	Manifestations of the Divine: the nature and importance of how the deities are shown in Hindu scriptures; avatars and murti; the nature and role of male deities: divergent understandings of the importance of Vishnu (including Rig Veda 1.22) and Shiva; the nature and role of the female force, Shakti, including Parvati and Lakshmi.
1.5*	The nature of the individual and life within Hinduism: the nature and importance of the atman (eternal self), karma, the cycle of samsara, moksha; divergent Hindu understandings of the nature of the individual and life, including interpretations of Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 4.4; why beliefs about the atman, karma, samsara and moksha are important for Hindus today.
1.6	The purpose of human life for Hindus: the nature and significance of the four aims of life (Purusharthas) – dharma, artha, kama and moksha; the nature and significance of anatana dharma (eternal law), including Bhagavad Gita 3.35; the nature and significance of varnashrama dharma (duties according to materialistic situation in life).
1.7	Hindu responses to suffering, knowledge and ignorance: Hindu teachings about suffering, knowledge and ignorance such as ahimsa, respect, empathy, mind/sense control, humility, and love, including Mahabharata 5.39; divergent Hindu understandings as to why there is suffering, knowledge and ignorance for Hindus today.
1.8	Hindu cosmology: the nature of the Hindu cosmology as shown in Hindu scriptures, including Rig Veda 10.129; the nature and importance of the cycle of four ages (yugas), including descriptions of the Kali Yuga in the Mahabharata, many worlds and their diverse inhabitants; the nature and divergent understandings of the importance of the concepts of prakriti (matter/nature), tri-guna (three qualities) and maya (illusion).

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	Revelation as proof of the existence of God; revelation as shown in the scriptures including in the Vedas, Agamas and the Bhagavad Gita 13.26–33; reasons why revelation might be important to Hindus and why it might not be; what revelation shows about the nature of God for some Hindus.
2.2	Visions as proof of the existence of God: the nature and importance of visions for Hindus; scriptural examples, including reference to Bhagavad Gita 11 and non-religious examples of visions; reasons why they might lead to belief in the existence of God and Hindu responses to non-religious arguments (including atheist and Humanist) which maintain that visions are hallucinations and provide no proof that God exists; divergent understandings of what visions show about the nature of God for Hindus.
2.3	Hindu attitudes towards numinous experiences: the nature and importance of numinous experiences for Hindus; scriptural examples with reference to Bhagavad Gita 12 and non-religious examples of numinous experiences; divergent understandings of why numinous experiences might lead Hindus to believe in the existence of God and reasons why they might not.
2.4	Miracles as proof of the existence of God: the nature and importance of miracles for Hindus; scriptural examples and non-scriptural examples of miracles, including the milk miracles (1995) and the story of Ganesha in Puranic literature; reasons why they might lead to belief in the existence of God and Hindu responses to non-religious arguments (including atheist and Humanist) which maintain that miracles can be scientifically explained and provide no proof that God exists; divergent understandings of what miracles show about the nature of God for some Hindus.
2.5	Hindu teaching about prayers: the nature and importance of prayers for Hindus, including Rig Veda 3.62; Hindu teachings about reasons prayers that are answered in the way the person expects might lead to belief in God; Hindu responses to non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding unanswered prayers and loss of belief.
2.6	Hindu teachings about the non-existence of a personal God: Hindu teachings which lead some Hindus to not believe in a personal God, including reference to Adi Shankara's Upadesa sahasri Chapter 1; the divergent implications of lack of belief in a personal God for Hindu life today.
2.7	Hindu attitudes towards religious experiences and its use as a philosophical argument for the existence of God, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 13.23–27: the nature of a religious experience for Hindus and why it might or might not be regarded as real; Hindu responses to non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments that religious experiences do not provide proof that God exists.
2.8	Religious upbringing: Hindu teachings about raising children to have a religious understanding of reality, including reference to Ramayan of Valmiki Canto 19; features of a Hindu upbringing and why they may lead to belief; Hindu responses to non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments which maintain that a religious upbringing is not required.

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	The nature and purpose of Hindu yoga: the nature and purpose of different forms of yoga, karma yoga (action), jnana yoga (knowledge), astanga/raja yoga (meditation) and bhakti yoga (devotion); examples of when each form of yoga might be used, how and why; the importance of having different types of yoga; reference to Bhagavad Gita 6.44–47.
3.2	Focuses of worship and representations of the divine: the nature, purpose and importance of different ways of worshipping, including worshipping one god (personal or non-personal) or many deities, gurus and holy places (land, hills, rivers and sacred plants and animals); the scriptural basis for the different focuses of worship and representations of the divine in worship, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 6.20–31.
3.3	The importance of Hindu places of worship: the nature, features of, use, and purpose of worship in different places, including in the temple, in the home, outside, shrines and festival celebration and in the space of the heart, with reference to interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 9.13–27; the benefits for Hindus of having different places to worship in.
3.4*	The nature and purpose of prayer in the temple and the home: the nature, features of use and purpose of the different forms of worship, including meditation, puja, havan, darshan, arti, bhajan, kirtan and japa, with reference to interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 6.44–47; divergent understandings of the benefits for Hindus of having different forms of worship.
3.5	Hindu sacred festivals: the nature, history, purpose and significance of Hindu sacred festivals; the origins and meaning of specific festivals, including Diwali, Holi, Navratri Dussehra, Ram Navami, Ratha-yatra, Janmashtami, and Raksha Bandhan, including interpretations of Brihadaranyaka Upanishad 1.3.28.
3.6	Hindu pilgrimage: the nature, history and purpose of Hindu pilgrimages; the significance of the places Hindus go on pilgrimage; divergent understandings of why pilgrimage may, or may not be, important for Hindus today; the nature, features, history and importance of pilgrimage to the Ganges including interpretations of Rig Veda 10.75, Vrindavana and Varanasi.
3.7	Hindu environmental projects: divergent understandings of the nature, purpose and significance of environmental care for Hindus; the importance of care for rivers and sacred places for Hindus; how Hindus care for the environment, examples of what they do and why, including reference to cow protection and interpretations of Rig Veda 10.87.16–19.
3.8	Hindu charity work: the nature and purpose of charity for Hindus; Hindu teachings about charity; the work of one named Hindu charity working to promote wellbeing, social inclusion and women's rights, what it does and why, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 3.10–12.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Hindu teaching on human rights: Hindu teachings and responses to the nature, history and purpose of human rights, including interpretation of Mahabharata 5.39, the importance of human rights and why Hindus might support them, including dharmic duty; the problems human rights might cause for Hindus. Humanist and atheistic arguments about human rights and Hindu responses to them.
4.2	Hindu attitudes towards equality: Hindu teachings and responses to the causes of inequality and problems caused by inequality in the world, including Rig Veda 10.90; Hindu teaching about equality, possible solutions and the reasons for them.
4.3	Hindu attitudes towards religious freedom: Hindu teachings and responses to the nature of religious freedom, including reference to Rig Veda 1.164.46 and Bhagavad Gita 4.11; the response of Hindus to a multi-faith society; the benefits and challenges for Hindus living in a multi-faith society.
4.4	Hindu attitudes to prejudice and discrimination: Hindu teachings and responses to the nature of prejudice and discrimination and the problems they cause, including links to situation ethics; Hindu teachings on why prejudice and discrimination against religions is wrong, including reference to interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 4.9–11; Hindu responses to non-religious arguments (including atheist and Humanist) against aspects of religious freedom.
4.5	Hindu attitudes towards racial harmony: Hindu teachings about racial harmony and those that may reflect ethical theories, such as situation ethics; how and why Hindus have worked for racial harmony, including Mahabharata 5.39 and the work of Mahatma Gandhi; the benefits of living in a multi-ethnic society.
4.6	Hindu attitudes towards racial discrimination: Hindu teachings and responses to racial discrimination, how and why racial discrimination causes problems in society, including reference to Mahabharata 5.39.
4.7	Hindu attitudes to social justice: Hindu teachings and responses to the nature and history of the distribution of wealth and opportunity in the UK and the world; Hindu teaching about social justice, including interpretations of Mahabharata, Book 9.60, and the way Hindus work for social justice; divergent Hindu, Humanist and atheist responses, including links to situation ethics.
4.8	Hindu attitudes towards wealth and poverty: Hindu teachings and responses to the nature and causes of poverty in the UK and in the world, including absolute and relative; Hindu teachings about wealth and poverty, including reference to artha and Rig Veda 10.117.